

VeriCase Product Positioning and Functional Blueprint

Make time your ally, not your enemy

Prepared for: William Rogers MCI Arb, Quantum Commercial Solutions

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1. Executive Summary

VeriCase focuses on one critical area and does it exceptionally well. We bridge the gap between raw project communications and a clear, defensible case narrative. The platform is built for high volume evidence intake and message level analysis with a clean chronology that counsel can trust. By avoiding product bloat and concentrating on evidence, chronology, claims, and rebuttal, VeriCase is more powerful and more cost effective than broad suites that dilute effort across many features.

2. Product Focus and Philosophy

- Specialise in the evidence to narrative bridge where the facts live in email and attachments.
- Be the pre litigation workspace that prepares law firm ready packs without replacing discovery platforms.
- Keep the application lean and fast with zero unnecessary modules.
- Use a core model that is domain agnostic with a Construction Add In enabled by default.

3. Unique Selling Propositions

- Message level precision with thread awareness so users always see who said what and when.
- Chronology Lens that merges multiple threads into one time ordered view across participants.
- Construction Add In that links evidence to programme activities and delay events without heavy scheduling tools.
- Rebuttal Mode that digests opponent submissions and surfaces counter evidence with citations in minutes.
- Strict audit trail with immutable message IDs and hashes in every export.
- Accessible pricing model with power features in the base tier.

4. Scope for MVP and Non Goals

In scope for MVP:

- Onboarding and configuration with Construction Add In defaults
- PST and EML ingestion including full body text and attachments with OCR
- Evidence list with faceted filters, preview, tagging, and AI suggestions
- Claims builder with Heads of Claim, narrative editor, and citation tool
- Rebuttal Mode with opponent document segmentation and suggested evidence
- Export of bundles with Bates numbering and manifest

Out of scope for MVP:

- Billing, time recording, and case diary
- Deep contract authoring and clause libraries
- Full scheduling analytics or programme calculation
- E billing or complex matter management

5. System Overview and Information Architecture

Core objects include Organisation, User, Matter, Party, Evidence Item, Email Message, Email Thread, Claim, Programme Reference, Submission, and Audit Log. Construction Add In extends metadata to include contract form, delay event type, and programme activity linkage.

6. Core Modules

6.1 Onboarding and Configuration

- Team invite with email based access for the lead user
- Setup wizard that offers Team, Case, and Project as first tasks
- Industry Add In selection with Construction enabled by default
- Mandatory fields for case setup such as parties, role, jurisdiction, and baseline dates
- Default taxonomies for evidence and claims to ensure tagging discipline

6.2 Evidence Ingestion and Management

- Upload PST or EML and ZIP with progress and status feedback
- Parse every message to an atomic Email Message with body text and attachments
- Threading via Message ID and References plus heuristics for poor data
- Quoted text detection and authored segment focus to reduce noise
- Faceted filters for date, participants, tags, document type, programme activity, linked claim
- Preview drawer with Details, AI Suggestions, Notes, and Audit
- Bulk tagging and link to Heads of Claim from the list view
- Saved searches for fast return to common views

6.3 Claims Builder

- Claims Tree for Heads and Sub heads with counts and status
- Narrative editor with insert citation that links to evidence with message IDs
- AI Evidence Finder that proposes sources based on the active section
- Programme chips and windows visible where Construction Add In is active
- Export to Word and PDF with citations intact

6.4 Rebuttal Mode

- Opponent submission upload and segmentation into numbered points
- Hybrid retrieval that ranks suggested evidence by content, date window, and participants
- AI Rebuttal Points that produce numbered arguments with mandatory citations
- Accept, edit, or reject workflow with full audit trail
- Defence Bundle export that pairs opponent points with our rebuttal and cited evidence

7. User Interface Principles and Accessibility

- Message first table with compact rows, authored excerpt, and a small thread map for context
- Right hand preview that shows body first with quoted history collapsed
- Chronology Lens to compare messages across threads and participants in time order
- Keyboard shortcuts for triage and tagging at speed
- Consistent high contrast branding with a distinct accent colour

8. End to End Workflow Example

Scenario. A contractor faces an adjudication concerning delays to Block C facade works. The project team needs to reconstruct the story and respond to an opponent submission under a tight timetable.

- Setup. The team leader invites colleagues and enables the Construction Add In. The programme baseline is uploaded and key parties such as NHBC and LJJ are defined.
- Ingest. PST archives from the project mailboxes are uploaded. VeriCase parses one million messages, removes near duplicates, and builds threads. All bodies and attachments are indexed.
- Triage. The Evidence list is filtered to March through July twenty twenty two and participants UL and LJJ. The Chronology Lens shows three threads concerning facade drawings. Pivotal messages are pinned.
- Claim build. A Head of Claim for design delay is created. The narrative editor cites emails and drawing logs with message IDs and timestamps. Programme chips show the planned start and actual impact window.
- Opponent reply. The opposing party files a reply asserting failure to mitigate. The team uploads the PDF and VeriCase segments it into points.

- Rebuttal. For each point, Suggested Evidence surfaces relevant emails and reports from the date window. AI Rebuttal Points propose numbered counters with citations. The team accepts and edits as needed.
- Export. A Defence Bundle is produced with a cover, the opponent points, our rebuttal points, and a manifest that includes message IDs, hashes, and source paths.

9. Differentiation versus Incumbents

Area	Incumbent Approach	VeriCase Approach
Email handling	Thread centric with heavy review sets	Message level with chronology and authored segments
Search and tagging	Powerful but complex with steep learning	Faceted filters and AI suggestions that remain optional
Programme context	Generic issue codes only	Construction Add In with programme linkage and delay event fields
Live rebuttal	Not a core workflow	Dedicated Rebuttal Mode with opponent segmentation and citations
Cost and access	Per gigabyte hosting costs and enterprise rollouts	Simple per user or per matter access with fast onboarding

10. Cost and Value Positioning

- Focus on the essential workflows that deliver the majority of value
- Reduce review time by collapsing noise and highlighting authored content
- Lower total cost through lean scope and efficient indexing rather than heavy compute
- Deliver enterprise grade audit and export in the base product

11. Configuration Standards for Quality Retrieval

- Mandatory fields for parties, role, jurisdiction, contract form, and baseline dates
- Default taxonomies for tags with autocomplete to prevent inconsistency
- Email to party mapping to resolve custodians and domains during ingest
- Dashboards that show untagged items and missing mandatory metadata
- Guardrails that block Rebuttal Mode if critical configuration is missing

12. Security, Audit, and Defensibility

- Immutable storage of raw EML with cryptographic hashes
- Per message audit for tags, links, and edits with before and after values
- Permission controls for BCC and sensitive fields
- Export manifests with message IDs, hashes, and source paths

13. Roadmap Outline

- Phase one. Ingest, indexing, Evidence module, and Chronology Lens
- Phase two. Rebuttal Mode and bundle exports
- Phase three. AI assisted drafting with strict citation rules and programme awareness
- Phase four. Additional industry add ins beyond construction

Appendix A. Glossary

- **Message ID.** Unique identifier for an email used to build threads
- **Authored segment.** The new content in a message excluding quoted history
- **Programme chip.** A visual indicator that links evidence to a programme activity or window
- **Bates numbering.** Sequential labelling of documents for disclosure
- **Construction Add In.** Optional domain pack that extends metadata and templates for construction disputes